Zombie Glimmadora Au

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/39694044.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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Zombie Glimmadora Au

by curiousscientistkae

Summary

The world has gone to utter shit. Zombies rule and humans struggles to live. For Adora, she keeps to herself. She has learned not to trust others and has good reasons for it. However, when another human, Glimmer, stumbles into her life, that goes right out the window

Notes

I wrote this like a year ago and never posted it lmao. I did go thru and edit it but yeah part 1 of 2. Though, my brain really likes the idea now and if the reception is good and people really want more, then MAYBE ill do more. I have so much to do already but if people like it what am I to do?

But yeah, gonna post some old fics while I wrote on werewolf au. Glimmer uses they/them in this and if i missed any, let me know sometimes I slipped when I was writing this

See the end of the work for more notes

Chapter 1

Chapter Notes

> Wrote this like a year ago and never posted lmao. Anyway I am posting old fics I never posted so yeah. This one I was going thru and if yall like it and REALLY want more, I might do so my brain has an itch but...ya know
>
> Anyway tw for blood and Injury and mentions of assisted suicide

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora drives her lucky knife through the zombie's skull. The sound of bones breaking and metal piercing through rotten flesh and brain matter fills her ears. Some dark blood splatters onto her dirt covered face. The zombie groans, pale lifeless eyes rolling back into their head. Blunt teeth, yet somehow sharp at the same time, loosen against her arm as their jaw becomes slack. Pulling the knife out, more dark blood oozes out of the wound, the blonde uses her now free hand to shove the corpse off her body. Freed, she pushes herself into a sitting position.

"Fuck," Adora sighs, looking at her left arm. The wound that splits her skin bleeds, pushing out the poisonous bacteria from her system. Thankfully, it will not take. She'll live to see another day as long as no other infection sets in. Best to clean it now. She takes a quick glance around, ensuring no other zombies appear out of thin air. With the coast clear, Adora removes her bag from her back and plops it on her lap.

A grumble escapes her as she pulls a water bottle out. Her meticulous planning on supplies now has been thrown out the window. With her extra bottles and caution when to drink (and hopefully the weather remaining cool) she should be able to last some time before needing to refill. With a sigh, Adora washes away blood and saliva from her arm. She pulls out a clean rag to

dry her skin and uses one of her oh so precious antibiotic wipes before wrapping the wound with a white cloth.

For good measure, Adora removes the dark jacket around her waist and slips it over her body. No need for anyone to ask questions. To think for a moment what lies under the bandages and not allow for an explanation before sending something through her head. She has survived this long without anyone new knowing her secret, no need to freak others out now.

After almost becoming lunch, the blonde decides this town is far too dangerous. Adora has lost count how many times zombies appeared as she was gathering supplies. This one happened to catch her at the perfect time. It hasn't been all for not, however. She managed to find some cans of food and pulled out some forgotten arrows in zombies' brains or picked those up littered on the ground.

"Time to go, Adora."

She stands to her feet, brushing off the dirt and dust that has collected on her clothing. Before heading out of this godforsaken town, Adora gathers the arrows that have fallen from their quiver, checks over her bow, and places her knife back in its covering. With everything back in order, the blonde begins her trek down the broken, deserted road. The forest awaits for her return. Ears and eyes remain alert. Abandoned cars, rundown buildings, and fallen debris are perfect hiding places for anyone that seeks to do harm.

How long has it been since the outbreak started? At least a couple years for sure. Adora still recalls that fateful day, watching the news as the undead came back to life and sought out the flesh of living humans. The sheer fear that gripped all of humanity. Brother betrayed brother. The second someone thought another was bitten, hysteria set in and many tore their homes apart in those man hunts. Society crumbled almost overnight and there are no signs at all of its return anytime soon. Not only are supplies of everything low, trust and hope are as well. Adora has no idea

how long it has been since the last time she didn't have a human trying to kill her or steal her things.

The last time she tried putting her faith in others, the odd-eyed woman she was with learned her immunity secret. She would throw Adora into the front lines, saying ` *Hey, you will be fine if you get bit. I won't'.* And then, later, used that secret and threw it back in the blonde's face. Tried to pawn her off to those that would experiment on her. Kill her in the quest for a cure that her body might not be able to give. If there is a way to reverse the plague, Adora would aid in that. But not against her will. Not when the chances are so low that a sacrifice might be for not.

Feet finally reach the threshold of the forest. Adora takes one last look over her shoulder at the town that almost ended her life. There is nothing left for her. The next town, Brightmoon if she recalls right, will take a week to get to. Hopefully there might be more there than here.

The fire is no more than a kindling. Small embers eat away at the charred, black wood. Smoke no longer forms, no way to let anyone know that Adora is here. The blonde nibbles on some rabbit she caught earlier the day. What's left has been safely tucked away in her bag for later use. Her knife, now clean, lies by her side. Daylight will be around for a little while longer. There is no need to rush towards her next destination. Adora is allowed to take a break.

With a piece of meat hanging from her mouth, Adora takes a moment to check on her bite wound. She carefully unravels the bandages on her forearm. At a week old, the injury has healed nicely. The scabbing is almost gone, leaving only ugly blue and brown bruising. A scar might form but she has ways of covering those up. This isn't her first rodeo. There doesn't seem to be a need for bandages anymore, thankfully.

Adora licks her lips. That rabbit sure made her thirsty. With her water beginning to dry up, she decides to fill up one of her

bottles. She made sure to settle down near a creek. Before getting up, the blonde does a scan of the area. No need for any animal or human to steal her hard earned supplies. With nothing in her sights or causing her ears to perk up, she grabs an empty bottle and some iodine. In a matter of steps, Adora reaches the moving water.

The creek is crystal clear. Adora can see all the minnows swimming against the current and the rocks shining in the sun. Water babbles in a language that she does not understand. If the apocalypse wasn't happening, she would take more time to appreciate the wonderful natural scenery. But she cannot linger for long. She cannot keep her back exposed or her supplies left all by their lonesome. Adora is quick to fill up her bottle with the water, adding several drops of iodine for good measure. The drawback to that addition is waiting. But it's waiting thirty-some-odd minutes or risk catching some illness.

With that all set and done, Adora begins to walk back to the spot she has claimed as her own. She does not think much of anything, just what there is to do before nightfall. However, that changes when she reaches her things. Digging through her bag, a rabbit foot in her hands, is a young stranger about her age. Short hair is as dark as a raven's feather. Eyes that are like a pair of amethyst gems twinkle in the sunlight. They are wide, full of shock, as Adora's own sky colored eyes lock onto them.

"HEY!" Adora blurts out first. "THAT'S MINE! PISS OFF!"

The stranger lifts their left hand, a rusted serrated knife grasped in their fingers. "All I want is this rabbit. Don't try and fuck with me since it doesn't seem you are armed."

Well, they've got her there. Stupid move on Adora's part to leave her own weapon behind. "Where the hell did you come from?!? And why the hell should you steal my shit?!?"

"You're the idiot who left it behind. And-" the stranger's eyes grow even larger, almost as if they take up their whole face. Adora

knows that look. She never covered up her bite wound.

"YOU'RE BIT?!?" the stranger accuses, knife pointed straight at Adora now. "DON'T YOU ***DARE*** COME CLOSER TO ME!"

"Wait! It's not what you think!" Adora does not think and a foot moves forward. That was no empty threat from the stranger. The next thing the blonde knows, she is pinned hard on the ground. Rocks dig into her spine and her head throbs from the blow. A knee against her chest makes breathing difficult. A knife is at her throat, Adora can feel a thin river of blood running down her skin.

The stranger's face is inches from her own. Amethyst eyes *burn* as more pressure is added to her chest. "Give me one good reason why I shouldn't kill you." they growl through gritted teeth.

"Wait wait!" Adora pleads. She manages to shove her arm between their faces. The blonde has been in this position before that the stranger is in. Behind that fire of fear, she can see that conflict within. Killing a zombie is one thing. Whatever human soul once called that body a home would have long since disappeared. But this is a whole different scenario. Even when bit, a human is a human. A living breathing being. Even if they shall turn into a hungry, bottomless pit, that soul still is *there.*

"Look!" Adora has to ensure she wins the conflict within the stranger. "It's healing! It's a week old! I-I-" she hesitates, words trapped in her tightened throat. Will they believe her? There is no other choice. "I'm immune!"

"What?" The stranger's eyes flick to the injury. They stay locked on the arm for a long time. Enough that Adora begins to feel the sweat from her forehead rolling down the side of her face. She attempts to gulp but the knife still poised at her neck prevents it.

"Why the fuck should I believe you?" the stranger asks.

"C-Cause...Cause...fuck it just take the rabbit, alright? Would that convince you not to kill me? I swear I will not turn and I won't attack you."

The stranger scoffs. “You’re lucky I am in a good mood today.”

Weight finally is removed from Adora’s chest. The blonde sucks in as much air as possible, lungs burning for the oxygen. The stranger returns to Adora’s bag, rummaging for the food.

Adora sits up, rubbing her neck. With a better view, she can see the stranger has seen better days. Though honestly, who hasn’t? Dark bags are under their eyes and it looks like they can collapse at any moment. That attack must have used almost all of their energy. The blonde has been there before, struggling to survive each day. Stomach eating itself for any semblance of food. Some days, she fears returning to that state. Despite almost being killed, how can she leave this stranger in this condition?

“Hey,” Adora starts.

The stranger snaps their head up, eyebrows raised.

“I know you just tried to kill me but, uh…” Adora rubs the back of her neck. “You don’t look that great.”

“I’m fine,” the stranger replies all too fast.

“Look. I promise I won’t kill you but I do have some extra food and water and was about to head into Brightmoon for supplies. Being alone isn’t a good idea and maybe we can work together, at least for now? Until you aren’t about to keel over?”

“So Brightmoon is that close, huh?” the stranger mumbles. Eyes go dark.

“What?”

“Nothing. Why should I trust you? I still don’t quite believe you won’t turn cannibal on me.”

Adora grabs the bottle of water that had been knocked out of her hands. “This still has to disinfect but you can have first dibs. I can get some more. Does that sound fair?”

The stranger does not move right away, gears turning in their head. Finally, they lift a hand up in the air. Adora sighs a breath of relief as she tosses the bottle over. “Name’s Adora Glenn.”

“Glimmer Mizari.”

Brightmoon is the by far the largest city Adora has been in for a while. From what little she knows of the area prior to the outbreak, this place was once bustling with life. A center for economics, culture, and tourism. People from all over the world would travel here to experience the wonder the city had to bring. Now, years after the outbreak, it’s nothing more than a desolate wasteland. Windows either are shattered or boarded up. Walls have graffiti sprayed all over, covering much of the brick or siding walls. Cars, many burned out or gutting for all their worth, are scattered around the road. If there are any zombies around, they lie in wait for their next meal.

Glimmer, so far, has not attempted to bash her brains in. However, they rarely let Adora out of their line of sight. Even back in the forest, sitting around the dying fire, eyes would follow her every movement. As long as there is not a repeat of their meeting (Adora’s chest and throat are still sore) then Glimmer can watch her like a hawk as much as they damn well please. Even with the daggers boring into the back of her skull, it is nice to have some company.

Though, she tries not to think much of it. No need to be backstabbed once again.

The sun begins to dip behind the row of buildings on the horizon. Night is the worst time to be out seeking to restore supplies. Adora insisted on reaching here once Glimmer had their fill of food and water. Being so close to the city, why not just get there right away instead of waiting around in the woods? The blonde has always been used to moving, not staying in one place for terribly long. The raven haired stranger, however, took some convincing. When pressed about it by Adora, wondering if it was a lack of

sleep, Glimmer shut their mouth. Only after hearing distant moans did both begin their trek to Brightmoon.

Adora cranes her neck over her shoulder, taking a glance at her new companion. Glimmer hobbles along, unable to keep up with the taller woman. No matter how hard Adora tries to slow down and match pace, Glimmer cannot keep up. This is not good at all. Both for the fact if they get jumped, it will not end well. Plus, she hates how Glimmer looks.

The paleness in their face. The bags under their eyes. The way their body looks far too heavy for their legs. Adora bites down on her lip as a knife drives itself through her heart. Only hours before, Glimmer attempted to kill her. Now, it looks like they can't even harm a fly.

'They'll die without you.'

"Fuck," Adora breathes out.

She searches harder for a place to rest. Somewhere no zombies will attempt to eat them. If Glimmer doesn't bounce back fast enough, whatever place they find will become a temporary stay. Hopefully, not a long one. Eventually, she finds a building that doesn't look completely run down. Adora stops in her tracks, pointing at the brick, four-story, structure.

"How about we stop here for the night?"

Glimmer pauses, taking a moment to check out the building. A frown forms on their face. Their eyes become dark. Glimmer shakes their head and begins to walk forward. "No. Not that place. We can find another."

"What the hell are you talking about?" Adora snaps. She blocks Glimmer, preventing them from taking any steps further. "Night is about to fall and you know that's the worst time to be out!"

"There are plenty of other places we can stay. It's not going to kill us to try and find another building."

“It might not kill me but have you looked at yourself lately? You have to rest.”

“We just met, why the hell do you care about me?”

Adora doesn’t have an answer. All words freeze in her throat as her brain struggles to come up with something. Why does she care? Adora pinches the bridge of her nose. “Look, do you want to live or not? I am going to go there. If you want to become zombie dinner, by all means, go ahead!”

Adora steps out of the way, gesturing for Glimmer to keep walking. She has made it this long on her own, why *should* she care? Glimmer very well could drag her down and be the death of her. The raven haired stranger huffs. Somehow, they manage to straighten themself out before moving their feet. However, Glimmer only makes it less than five steps before their body crumbles.

There barely is enough time to react. Barely enough time for her brain to understand what on earth is going on. Arms instinctively shoot out, preventing Glimmer from colliding with the ground. The weight of their limp body does bring the blonde to the broken street. However, her knees break the fall. Scuffs are the least of Adora’s worries currently.

“Glimmer?!? Hey!” Adora shouts. No answer. She flips Glimmer around so they can be face to face.

Glimmer’s gasps for breath. Their face has lost much of its color, only the flush of red against their nose and cheeks can be seen. Beads of sweat rest on their brow. Adora doesn’t need to touch Glimmer’s forehead to know they are *burning.*

Adora must really have a death wish right now. “That’s it! You are coming with me!” she shouts. The blonde swiftly stands to her feet and makes a beeline towards the building. She uses her shoulders to push open the door half on its hinges. First floor is not good. A swarm of zombies can easily overwhelm them in this

area. Adora decides to travel up the stairs, all the way towards the top.

Not only is it a struggle to carry a whole ass other person up four flights of stairs, but the stairs themselves prove to be a problem. Many groan under their combined weights, threatening to splinter. At some points on the way up, there is nothing to support them. Adora strains herself to continue her flight. Hopefully zombies won't be as determined.

Finally, there becomes nothing less to climb. At the top floor, there is only one door. Shut. Adora wastes no time in busting the door down. Somehow, after all these years, the lock has remained intact. With zero keys and little time to pick, Adora slams her foot near the doorknob. After several hard kicks, it flies open.

Inside is like a time capsule. Aside from the fine layer of dust and sun-faded walls and curtains, the apartment is untouched. The TV is still plugged in. A table is made up, plates are ready to have food placed on top of them. There even is a bookshelf just waiting for someone to take one of their stories and read them. Other doors are shut and Adora wonders if they have to be kicked down as well.

Adora sets Glimmer down on the couch before quickly shutting the door. For good measure, she grabs one of the chairs from the dining table and sets it under the doorknob. *This better be as good of a lock as the other.*

"Hey!" Adora scrambles back towards the couch. "Hey! Are you awake?!?"

Glimmer lets out a groan, eyes still squeezed shut. "Stop… yelling…"

"Oh thank god, you're not dead. Are you hurt somewhere?"

Glimmer slowly cracks open their eyes. Lights remain in the amethyst irises but have dimmed and remain unfocused. Their

breathing has neither gotten better nor worse. They licks dry lips before hoarse words escape them.

“S-Shouldn’t…Shouldn't have brought me…here.”

“And let you crack your head open on the pavement? Zombies would just love a free meal like that!” Adora takes a breath, attempting to let her body settle. Her heart is threatening to burst out of her chest and she finds her own breathing difficult. Images flash in her mind.

Her brother, mother, and father. Her friends and neighbours. The groups she joined before. All either became bloody and broken or Adora was forced to end their suffering as they rotted away, only hungry for flesh. The choices she had to make.

The power she lacked…

"Glimmer. *Please* tell me what's going on. Where are you hurt? I have to treat your wound if it's infected."

"L-Leg...Left," Glimmer finally says. "Cut it on...a fence."

Finally, Adora gently places her hands against Glimmer's leg. The moment they hisses through their teeth, she knows where the wound hides. She grabs her lucky knife and uses its teeth to tear away the fabric of Glimmer's pants. Once removed, she throws the useless object towards the side.

The wound at first glance isn't much. Whatever piece of the fence got them didn't go deep. Just left a long mark. However, it's *red* and *hot.* Adora wonders if the metal was rusted and how long Glimmer has gone without tending to it. Maybe they didn't think anything of the injury. Who would honestly?

Okay. First thing’s first. Adora damps a rag and quickly washes the wound off. Glimmer bites their lip at each brush. The blonde has no idea if this is doing any good. But it is a start. After the first step, it’s time for the next. However, she runs into a problem.

With the infection already set in, what she has in her bag might not be enough. *Damn it.*

"I'm going to see if the bathroom has anything left," Adora states. She looks at all the closed doors in her field of view. Will any of them hold what she needs?

"Go down the hall…" Glimmer starts. Their eyebrows knit together as they attempt to string words together in a sentence. "First on the right."

"Right." Adora jogs down the hall, quickly reaches the door Glimmer specified. Just as her fingers wrap around the handle, the blonde pauses. A thought quickly passes through her mind, wondering how Glimmer knows this is the bathroom. However, Adora quickly shakes the thought from her mind. Time is precious.

Adora pushes the door open. She is met with a small bathroom. A shower, toilet, sink with a cabinet below, and a mirror attached to the medicine cabinet. Adora quickly begins to rummage through it. There are expired bottles of pills, a box half filled with bandaids, a couple of wrappings, and the holy grail of what she needs. An unopened bottle of hydrogen peroxide.

She snatches the bottle and wrappings before heading back into the living room. Glimmer refuses to shut their eyes. They follow Adora around, just like they always have. Adora kneels back down beside the couch and tears open the seal to the bottle.

"This is going to hurt like a bitch," Adora states as she wets her rag.

"Can't be as bad as this fever," Glimmer attempts to laugh.

Adora wastes no time. She places the rag against the cut. To no one's shock, Glimmer's body jerks *hard.* They bite down hard on their lip, barely able to suppress a cry. Adora mutters an apology several times as she cleans off the infected wound. Once she feels like it's as clean as can be, she quickly wraps it up. There remains

one last thing. With a new rag, she uses even more water on it and places it against Glimmer's forehead.

"The rest is up to you, now. Don't die on me, alright?"

"I'll try not to," Glimmer grins. Their eyes finally flutter shut. Breathing remains uneven but not as harsh as before. That is something to be relieved over.

Adora sighs through her nose. She leans back against her hands. Barely a day has passed since meeting Glimmer but it feels like a lifetime has gone by. All because she left for water and Glimmer wanted something to eat. Now, Adora has found herself with the responsibility of keeping them alive. What would have happened if their paths never collided?

She'd rather not think about that. Adora stands up and takes a moment to stare out the window. Night has almost completely fallen. It's time to hunker down. The blonde takes the time to properly secure the area. She finds a stronger chair to use as a doorstop. Heck, she finds an *actual* doorstop to shove under the small gap. Once that is set, she shuts all the shades and blinds and does a quick sweep of the apartment. No zombies or hidden enemies in the two bedrooms or the closets.

Looking for supplies can wait until the morning. With everything checked out and no signs of any threats, Adora reenters the living room. Glimmer, now deep in slumber, snores. Hopefully, they'll remain asleep for a while. Adora takes a seat on the single sofa. Despite the fact it can hinder her if she needs to get up fast, she tucks her legs under her body. With her knife and bow nearby, and the apartment secured, she lets her tired body drift off.

Glimmer sleeps. Their breathing starts to get better but remains off. Adora wishes she could find a thermometer. Glimmer's forehead remains warm but she swears that it isn't as bad as the day before. That does not ease Adora's worry at all. So she lets

them sleep. She does, however, leave some water and a small bit of rations on the coffee table.

Adora begins to check the apartment for supplies. Now with two people, one of which is incapacitated, she needs to replish. No way can she leave Glimmer alone in the state they are in. Rationing will only last them so long. The first place she checks is the kitchen.

There are several canned goods, enough to last them a while actually. Adora remains amazed how this place has survived the years of anarchy. Of course, the stove needed to cook half the stuff does not work. She has her portable camping one that is used in emergencies or when she is stuck in a place with no firewood. Adora just has to check how much gas is left in it.

Water, of course, is cut off, and no bottles are in sight. That will be the thing to worry about. Already, her mind races with ideas of dehydration or being too fast searching for water, she gets ones that are tainted. What a way to go out—by bacteria in her drink. Adora slaps the sides of her face, trying to rid her mind of that idea.

Stop! Stop Adora! Go search for something else.

Adora exits the kitchen and begins searching the other rooms. She checks the cabinet in the bathroom. Most of the stuff is cleaning supplies. There really isn't anything useful. Can't even barter for anything good with this stuff. With a huff, Adora checks the room across from the bathroom. A bedroom for a single person. Rummaging around the dresser, she finds some new pairs of pants that might fit Glimmer.

There isn't much else to note. Adora removes some batteries from a remote and an old gameboy, hoping they still have some juice left. With nothing else useful, she checks the last room. It's a master bedroom. Whoever has lived here has many photos on their nightstand. Adora does her best to ignore them, not wanting

a face to be put to lives lost. There has been enough of that. Like before, there isn't much.

Clothes will not fit either of them. There isn't any food stashed away or things that can be used as weapons. She does pull out a couple more batteries. The last thing she finds is something she has been looking for for months. A flashlight! Adora gives it a little shake before testing it out. By some miracle, it works.

"Finally, something useful!" Adora chirps.

She begins to make her way out of the bedroom with her small collection. As she does so, try as she might, the photos catch Adora's attention. A husband and wife stand in one on what looks like their wedding day. Another has them out on a beach, the husband holding his wife in his arms, both with broad smiles on their faces. Finally the last one is them as parents. A young child with a gap tooth smile stares back.

They cause Adora to freeze in her tracks.

Raven black hair, amethyst eyes. There are no signs of trauma from trying to not be eaten by zombies or betrayed by friends. Everything about the child shows off hope and joy and love for their parents. It's a moment frozen in time of a better yesterday.

Oh.

It takes a week for Glimmer to begin getting back on their feet. For the first couple days, Adora almost has to force Glimmer to eat. They don't like the idea of being fed like a baby, however, they barely have enough energy to do it themselves. Eventually, they give in and allow Adora to spoon feed. Slowly, Glimmer finds their footing again. They wobble around the apartment, needing walls to help them stay upright.

Adora uses this opportunity, one day, to dip out for a couple hours to search for water. After aimlessly wandering around, killing several zombies in the process, she locates a rundown

supermarket. The windows have long since been shattered and even from this distance, Adora can see many of the shelves are barren. She takes a breath before slipping inside.

Can I really find anything here? Adora asks herself. All she can find is dust or some rats skittering across broken tiles. Much of what she finds has expired a long time ago. She pushes back some boxes, looking for anything. By the time she has walked through every abandoned aisle, all Adora has to her name are two bottles. They won't last long. She and Glimmer have to start moving again.

She spins on her heels, ready to head out. Just as the world comes into focus, the dead, decaying body of a zombie appears. Only inches away. Adora holds back a surprised cry and begins reaching down for her knife. She only manages to slash the tip of her weapon across their face before the zombie forces her to the ground.

Adora grunts, teeth gritted. Dark, sticky blood oozes onto her face as she falls. Using the momentum, she manages to stick her feet against their stomach, rolls backwards, and sends them flying. The zombie slams against the wall, knocking down photos. Their glass shatters and sprinkles across the ground.

Shit, that made a lot of noise!

Adora feels the hair on the back of her neck stand at attention. She doesn't waste another second. She does *not* want to see how many zombies heard the commotion. Adora gets the hell out of dodge.

Some zombies do appear, however. A good five or six. Not a fair fight at all when you only have a knife and limited number of arrows. Plus, after spreading the week taking care of Glimmer, her energy isn't as high as it should be. Adora makes a sharp turn and ducks into an alleyway. She slaps a hand over her mouth, stifling her heaving breathing. When the small horde finally passes by, she races back to the apartment.

Adora does not return to the apartment until dusk. Between avoiding any zombies she spots and taking several wrong turns, she has no idea how she made it back alive in one piece. Her lungs beg for air and legs wish for rest. But there are still four flights of stairs to travel. Upon reaching the door, Adora knocks, using the patterns and beats she and Glimmer agreed on.

After several moments of waiting, the door opens up. Glimmer stands in the frame. Their eyes are wide and full of worry. A hand shoots out and grips the front of Adora's shirt. The blonde is yanked inside.

"Where the hell were you?!?" Glimmer asks as they shut and relock the door.

"Looking for supplies?" Adora replies. She throws her bag near the couch before flopping face first against it. Her body sighs in relief, especially her feet.

"Yeah but you said you'd be back relatively quickly! I thought you weren't gonna be long!"

Adora flips over on her back. One arm rests against her stomach while she talks with her other. "Had a brush with a zombie. Only got a couple bottles of water before I had to book it out of there. And I might have gotten a little lost. Brightmoon sure as hell has a lot of twists and turns."

Glimmer sighs. Adora watches them grab their own rag before kneeling down. "Let me get this gunk off your face."

Adora immediately snaps up before the damp cloth can touch her cheek. "Ah! Y-You don't have to do that!" she stammers.

Glimmer raises an eyebrow. "That was quite a reaction…But you have been babying me for the past week. I'd be zombie lunch long ago if it wasn't for you. This is the least I can do."

"It's nothing but zombie blood. No big deal." Adora slowly lets her body relax.

“Just lie back down, will you? Don’t make me use force.”

Almost fully recovered, there is a fire in their eyes. One that says ‘ *don’t test me’* . Exhausted from her ‘adventure’, Adora gives in. She lies back against the couch. Glimmer slowly places the rag against her cheek.

“Sorry for the reaction before. I don’t like people touching my face. Always have.”

“Oh, is this okay? I can stop.”

Adora shakes her head. “It’s alright.” To be honest, she would be lying if she said she hated this. The touch of another human is nice. Adora forgot how much she has longed for something like this. Glimmer’s touch is so soft, so gentle…Adora feels her body relax further.

“Did you get hurt at all? Bit?” Glimmer asks as they finish cleaning off her face.

“No. If anything my back is gonna be sore from being knocked over but I’m fine otherwise.”

“Do you mind if I ask about that? Being immune.”

“We really getting into backstories now?” Adora jokes. She props herself up on her elbows.

“I’ll tell you mine if you tell me yours. Beside’s, what else do you do in a zombie apocalypse? Play monopoly?”

Adora chuckles. “Alright. I’ll go first then.”

Before speaking, Adora takes a long, deep, inhale. She preps herself to start where everyone’s story begins. The start of the zombie apocalypse. Being at home from college and spending time with her brother and parents. The chaos of the first few weeks is one giant blur. All the fighting, the fear, the confusion…

How many places did Adora see being burned to the ground because the world was crumbling around them.

Of course, even as things settled down, that didn't mean life gave anyone breaks. Adora had seen death before. Others slowly dying from the infection or being murdered for everything they had. But when her parents died trying to protect her and her brother, that was the first real blow. The first time she lost anyone close to her.

Speaking about it now threatens to bring tears to her eyes. A knife slowly inches its way deeper and deeper into her heart as she continues her story. The worst has yet to come.

Things had begun to *actually* settle down. Adora and her brother got used to life on their own and how to survive. However, they got cocky. Thought they were invincible and nothing could harm them. That all came crashing down when a bunch of zombies jumped them. By the time the siblings got away and to safety, they quickly realized the extent of their injuries. Both had been bitten.

Neither knew what to do. What do you do when you and your sibling are infected with zombie bacteria? So, they waited. Waited to figure out what they were going to do and how they would go about the unthinkable. However, as Adora's wound healed and she remained healthy as can be, her brother deteriorated— *quickly.*

There was no choice. Her brother asked— *begged* —Adora to put him out of his suffering. Tears had run down both their faces as her brother reassured her it was okay, he wanted to die by his sister's hands and not some stranger, and that he loved her. His last words were ' *Keep fighting on until you find home again.'*

Adora still cannot fire a gun to this day.

"There isn't much to note after that. The usual happened. Finding groups, people dying, moving on." Adora struggles to keep her voice from breaking any further than it already has. "Had some

people try to kill me when they saw a bite wound without realizing I was immune or they found out and used me as bait."

She suddenly feels a squeeze of her hand. Glimmer. They have misty eyes themself as they rub a thumb against Adora's skin.

"That's...well horrible," they state.

"What isn't these days?" Adora retorts. She wipes her face clean with her arm. "Well. Your turn."

"Right." Glimmer leans back on their hands. Eyes flutter shut as they think. "Well, for starters, Brightmoon is my home."

"And this is your apartment, isn't it?" Adora asks.

"Yeah. Guess you figured that out while I was passed out. Can't believe you ended up bringing me here. Anyway, it was me, my mom, and my dad when shit hit the fan. With my mom being mayor she tried to keep order. We were here for a while before we had to leave. Still can't believe no one looted this place.

"But one day a bunch of bandits or whatever you want to call those who get a kick out of the end of the world showed up. Found the group we had. Only…" they pause for a moment. "Only I and two other people my age escaped."

"I hate those people," Adora grumbles.

"Tell me about it." Glimmer reopens their eyes. "And honestly I don't have much else to say. Like you. Going from group to group, trying to live. I don't have such a tragic backstory as you do."

"A tragedy is still a tragedy."

"Yeah well, I've been alone since then. Somehow I haven't died yet."

Adora rubs the back of her neck. "Well. You don't have to be. We have already been together for like a week. Why not stay

together?"

Glimmer raises an eyebrow. "Are you seriously thinking that after I tried to kill you?"

"Pft. That's nothing, don't worry. What do you say? It's better than being alone."

"You have a point there. Deal." Glimmer then stands to their feet. "I will take the first watch. You need the rest."

"So do you. You're still healing!"

"I don't want to lie around anymore. Plus," Glimmer stops at the curtain drawn window. Their shoulders curl slightly and hands hold arms. Eyes look through the slit. "I'd like to be alone for a little, ya know?"

"Oh. Yeah. Just wake me if you need anything."

Adora waits, an arrow set and ready to sail through the air. She dares not take a peek. These zombies still have some of their eyesight. No need to move and alert them. Glimmer will let her know when. Out of the corner of her eye, she sees her new found friend peering out from the corner.

The low moans fill Adora's ears, growing louder and louder. Adora struggles to keep her hands steady. She is about to say fuck it herself and fire the arrow herself. Before she can do anything, Glimmer whistles.

Adora snaps up without missing a beat. She lets go of her arrow. The sharp point enters their eye and exits out the back of their skull. The zombie groans before falling down. Adora sighs in relief.

"Nice job," Adora says. She removes the arrow and puts it back in her quiver.

“You’re a hell of a shot.” Glimmer states. “Don’t think I could ever do that.”

“Well I had a lot of time to practice. We make a good team, huh?”

Glimmer rolls their eyes. “Come on. You are cooking dinner tonight.”

Chapter End Notes

Comments/kudos appreciated

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

> When I wrote this kind of gave up but ye. Tw for blood injury, near death, nudity mention and surgery

Adora stares up at the universe above her. If there is *one* good thing about the apocalypse, it's that she can see an arm of the Milky Way. Where she grew up, the lights would drown out most of the stars above. Adora was lucky to see a handful of them but never to this degree. Even though the years have passed since first seeing the universe in full, it never has lost its magic. She could look at them forever.

But she can't. Not tonight. Adora is on watch currently. So far, there hasn't been any attempts for something to eat her and Glimmer's brains out. It has been roughly a month or so since the two decided to team up and it has been relatively boring. Nothing much has happened for being at the end of the world. Killing some zombies, searching for food, hunting, just the usual.

The only ***un*** usual thing is bonding with Glimmer. Most tides have been served in this hell of a world and trust is rarer than ammo. Yet, there the two are, having each other's backs. Despite their smaller size, Glimmer is a heck of a fighter. The two once wrestled each other for fun and to blow off steam and Adora ended up pinned to the ground, much to her shock. Hell, that moment still is clear as day in her mind. The way the sun outline Glimmer's body and the stupid ass grin on their face.

She loves that new memory.

But right now, Glimmer is knocked out cold. They snore slightly but not loud enough to attract any attention. Honestly, Adora loves listening to the noise. It's kind of cute. For once, a noise does not cause her fight or flight to go into high gear.

Adora decides to stretch out her legs. She jumps to her feet and begins walking around the small campsite. The two have found a small spot on some cliffs in the woods. Down below, more trees reach for the sky while a large river cuts through the earth below. Maybe if Adora and Glimmer can find a way down there without breaking their necks they can go fishing. Or, better yet, take a bath.

The fire from before has long since died. Not even embers burn. Only the dark ashes of wood remain. Thank god the weather has remained fair. Adora doesn't really know what she is gonna do once winter sets in. Heading down south poses its own risk. But that is something that they will have to deal with later.

Adora takes a couple steps into the woods. She rubs a hand against the trunks of trees, especially those of maple. As a child, her and her family would travel to tap their own maple syrup. That is definitely something she misses from the time before. Both her family and the sweetness of pure sugar. Adora tries not to dwell on thoughts of the past long. What's the point when the future holds hold but death?

A snap of a twig catches her attention. Adora spins around so fast she is surprised she doesn't snap her neck. Thankfully, there is no threat. Only Glimmer, with their hands up in the air. "Sorry!" they say.

"Christ, you scared me half to death!" Adora hisses through her teeth.

"Again, sorry. I just woke up and saw you over here." Glimmer lowers their arms and saunters over next to Adora. "What are you doing anyway?"

"Nothing really," Adora shrugs. "Just had to get some blood flowing, ya know? And I kind of started…thinking…"

"That's never good. Do you want to sleep it off? Since I am awake I can take over."

“You don’t have to do that.”

“Eh, once I am up I am up. Don’t worry.” Glimmer gives a nudge with their shoulder. “Get some rest.”

If Adora is being honest, she really could use some rest. Adora pats Glimmer’s shoulder, wishing them luck and to wake her if they need anything. She lays down on her section of the dead fire. Her eyes follow Glimmer walking around, scanning the area for anything important or dangerous. Her eyelids become heavy and there is no use in fighting back sleep anymore. The last thing she sees is Glimmer doing the same thing she was doing earlier. Staring up at the stars.

Eventually, Glimmer and Adora make it down to the river. The blonde is more than happy to finally be in a body of water. It’s been a while since she last got to dip her toes in something this nice. Adora sighs in relief as she places her feet in the river. Glimmer is the first to make the decision on bath.

They strip out of their clothing, revealing skin riddled with scars from fights and lord knows what else. Adora finds herself unable to pull her eyes off of Glimmer. Loving the scars, the curves on their body, the wing tattoos on their back, and the way the sun outlines their body in a soft halo. Even the shimmer water highlights them. Though, the moment they look over their shoulder, Adora snaps her head away, turning a bright red and feeling a hot fire in her chest. She hears Glimmer chuckling before encouraging Adora to clean off herself.

She does join them, actually, though remains beet red the whole time. Adora tries to cool off by dipping herself under the water or splashing it on her face. But every time she spots Glimmer, the warmth returns. Her new found friend seems to enjoy the torment, chuckling each time. Though, they eventually start a splashing war, helping distract Adora from racing thoughts.

Once they are back in their clothing, Adora and Glimmer decide to fish for their lunch. When some wood is set up for when they catch their meal, the pair hops back into the water. In their hands are quickly made spears.

“Have you ever done this before?” Adora asks. Her eyes see a fish swimming by. She attempts to spear it but the tip only hits the rocks below. Adora curses as she watches her lunch disappear.

“A couple of times.” Glimmer throws their own spear into the water. Nothing but dirt. “I’ve used makeshift fishing poles more in the past or just stuck with land animals.”

“It’s been a hot while for me. It is a little fun. Ah!” Adora thrusts her spear into the water once more. This time, it makes its mark. She pulls out a perch looking fish.

“That’s one meal down, one more to go!” Adora beams.

“You really think that’s going to be enough. Looks a little small, to be honest.”

Adora shrugs. Once the fish stops moving, she tosses it near the wood. “Better than nothing. Can’t be picky in the apocalypse!”

The two start to pick up the pace. In fact, it becomes a game! Adora and Glimmer compete to see who gets the most fish and the fewest misses. Heck, they start tripping the other up. Splashing water in one’s face, making a noise that starles the fish in the other direction, you name it. In the end, Adora ends up with three fish and Glimmer four. The latter of which absolutely revels in.

“Shut up!” Adora shouts. She splashes some water at Glimmer. They only laugh as they start up the fire.

“Good to know you are a sore loser,” Glimmer teases. “I will keep that in mind the next time we do something like this.”

“I am not a sore loser. I just know if the sun’s reflection didn’t blind me I would have won.”

“Sure. Keep telling yourself that.”

Adora begins to clean up the fish, getting them ready to be eaten, as Glimmer sets the campfire. While fish isn’t her favorite food, Adora can't wait until she has an actual good meal for the first time in forever. She begins to get another ready to prep when she notices Glimmer standing up.

“There we go,” Glimmer cleans off their hands and looks proud of their work. “This should last for a while.”

Adora is about to say something when something catches her eyes. Her hand quickly grabs the spear besides her and she jumps onto her feet. “Glim, duck!”

Glimmer does as they are told without thinking. They hit the deck as Adora throws the spear through the air. It hits its target dead center in the zombie’s chest. As the threat falls to the ground, Adora races over. Before they can get up and attempt to bite anyone, she shoves her knife through their brain.

“Damn. Save me again,” Glimmer states as they stand up.

“Guess I am winning in one aspect.” Adora removes her spear from the zombie’s chest. “You gotta start saving my ass. I can’t keep pulling all that weight.”

Glimmer rolls their eyes. They turn back to their work, pulling out a small box of matches they had found a couple days ago. It does not take long for them to get a fire going, thankfully, with only one match. She shoves the rest back in her pocket before placing skewered fish above it to cook. Adora scans the area briefly, making sure the zombie has no buddies with them, before joining Glimmer by the fire.

The pair talk about their upcoming plans. In about a week or so, depending on how fast they walk, they will reach a new city. A

new place to restock their supplies. A new place to remain on guard. Who knows what dangers will be lurking there. Adora tries not to think much about it. Just another day in the life of the zombie apocalypse. What she does think about, however, is heading there with *Glimmer.*

She cannot imagine a life without Glimmer now. It only has been a short time together yet Adora already has forgotten how she survived without a friend. How did she never die without someone watching her back? How did she not go insane without the company of another living being? How did she not starve to death without the aid of another? All of these questions, Adora cannot answer. All she does know is she does not want to lose this.

She doesn't want to live a life without Glimmer.

"What the fuck are you staring at?" Glimmer suddenly asks. Violet eyes are wide.

"Eh?"

"You're staring off into space and you also look like you are thinking about something."

Adora's face goes warm, warmer than it ever has before. She coughs, clearing both throat and mind. "Nothing! Well, not *nothing* nothing but nothing in particular. Just what we were gonna do when we hit the next city. Gotta be ready for anything, right?"

Glimmer raises an eyebrow. " *Alright.* I guess it would be a good idea to plan. But I think right now," they reach towards the fire and grab a freshly cooked fish. "I think we deserve something nice."

Adora smiles as she grabs the swerked fish from them. "I cannot argue with that!"

They continue their travel, stopping for nothing in particular. Some scuffles with zombies crop up but nothing out of the ordinary. They survive off of whatever they can forage off of trees and bushes or small mammals they manage to catch. Glimmer is skilled with trapping. They show Adora how to make a proper snare. In return, she shows them some new fighting moves. They pick it up relatively fast, easily able to knock Adora on her ass.

Nights are spent switching on and off for sleep. Though, at least one of them both remain awake, neither able to rest. In the distance, the tall, broken, and deserted buildings of the city stand. In only a couple days they will be inside facing who knows what. There could be a horde of zombies or nothing to sneeze at. Who knows what types of humans lurk inside. But there isn't much of a choice, is there?

"Are you ready for this?" Adora breaks the silence that falls between them. "The last time we were in something as big as this place, well, you nearly kicked the bucket."

Glimmer snorts. "Yeah. Let's not let that happen again." They lean back on their hands. "I just want to get in and out. Find the shit we need and forget about this place. I don't want to stay there too long."

It's Adora's turn to lean back. She stares at the city, wondering what it would have looked like years ago. All the lights, the people streaming through the streets even late at night, and all the life hidden within buildings. Her imagination is a far cry from the reality of today. Still, she can't help but wonder.

"Hey, Glim. Do you think there are any places left where we don't have to keep moving?" she asks.

"Like a safety zone?" Glimmer inquiries.

"Yeah. I mean, you always hear about them in passing. I did. Never saw them though. But don't you ever get bored and tired of always being on the move? Of always running for your life and not

knowing if you will see tomorrow? I know we can't go back to life before the apocalypse but…at least having that *safety* back would be nice, ya know?

"I get ya." Glimmer answers. "I never saw any safety zones myself. I figured they are fake or if they are real, anarchy caused them to fall. It would be nice but I don't want to put all my faith, or any really, into something that might not even be real. I just want to live to see tomorrow and go from there."

"Fair. Sorry if that sounds like a child's fantasy." Adora rubs the back of her neck. "I'm just thinking out loud."

"No, it's okay. I might not fully believe in that but, I like that *you* do."

Adora sees a small smile spread across their face. Their eyes stay fixated on the distant city, though, she can see flecks of bright lights growing in them. "I never was that hopeful but knowing you are thinking about that, honestly, it makes me feel a little better."

Adora can't help but grin herself. Her heart flutters around in her chest. For a moment, her hand inches itself towards Glimmer's wishing to hold it as they stare at the near future they'll have to face. However, she stops short. Fingertips nearly brush fingertips but the smallest of gaps remain. An invisible knife slices through Adora's heart as she returns to the silence with Glimmer.

So far, the city is devoid of life. No humans other than Adora and Glimmer. No birds watching from rooftops with their black, beady eyes. No stray dogs rummaging around for scrapes to gnaw on. Hell, there are barely any zombies around. The ones the duo do spot are so slow and non-threatening that they simply fast walk right past them with no issues.

"How about we check here first?" Glimmer suggests, pointing out a small looking warehouse. Adora nods, following their lead. After

a quick scan of the area, seeing no life or death, they begin their search.

At first there isn't anything of interest. Broken glass, empty cans of food, and at least two broken bats. There even is a car, stripped of wheels and many of its parts. Glimmer decides to check if there is any gas they could be of any use but, alas, there isn't any.

Though, luck suddenly falls right into their laps. While Glimmer is checking out one area, Adora turns a corner. She spots a shelf with several items resting on them. Upon closer inspection, she sees boxes of ammo, some unbroken bottles, and at least one small kit. Adora opens it, seeing some medical supplies. Mostly bandages but there also is a set of sewing needles and spools. A shiver runs down her spine at the thought of being stitched up with this.

The thought goes away quickly. “Yo, Glim! Get over here!”

The echoes of footsteps fill the air. In a matter of moments, Glimmer appears. They moment their eyes land on things in her hands, they race over. “Woah. I honestly didn’t expect us to find anything, let alone something like this!”

“We hit a nice little jackpot, huh?” She takes a moment to look around, craning her neck and almost pulling a muscle. “There isn’t anyone around, right?”

Glimmer shakes their head. “No. We are in the clear. But let's get the hell out of here before someone *does* show up.”

They quickly stuff their bags before getting the hell out of dodge. More searching for supplies. Luck only appears in that one place. While Glimmer and Adora find some more food and water, among other things, it takes some time to get everything they need. By the time bags have been *somewhat,* afternoon has begun to set in.

Glimmer suggests it is time to leave. Adora does not protest this. Better not overstay their welcome. She does a quick check of their restored supplies before throwing her bag back over her shoulders.

They should have left earlier.

Glimmer and Adora only make it half way towards the outskirts of the city, something sails through the air. Out of the corner of her eye, Adora sees Glimmer wince and cups their cheek. Behind them, an arrow bounces off the pavement. In front of the duo, a sudden, small group of masked bandits appear.

“Looks like we got some people who think they can walk in on anyone’s turf without permission.”

The one who speaks, possibly the leader, rests their crossbow on their shoulder. They look at their friend, all four of them, before setting their sights back on Adora and Glimmer. “So, we can do this the easy way or the hard way.”

All the bandits' weapons point at the duo. The leader continues their speech. “You can either give us all the stuff you stole *plus* everything else you have as compensation. Do that and maybe we won’t kill ya. Or, you can try and fight us and see how that goes.”

Glimmer steps forward, hitting a fist against their palm. Blood from the thin red line on their cheek drips down to their chin. “I think you already decided that for us.”

They reach down and put a knife. Adora wastes no time in grabbing her own. Before the bandits can process the challenge, the two charge forward. Adora quickly goes for the leader, giving them a clean punch to the face before they can reload their weapon. They topple backwards yet remain on their feet. While this happens, the rest of the group recovers from the shock.

Adora dodges a punch to the head. She drops to the ground, using her leg to sweep her foe off their feet. They fall to the

ground, hitting their head against the pavement, and knocking themselves out. There is no time to waste.

Glimmer already is winning a fight with their chosen opponent. Though, with their back turned, they fail to see the leader coming at them with their crossbow pointed at their head. For a moment, Adora sees nothing but red as she propels her body forward. She connects with the leader, bringing them straight out to the ground before they can fire their weapon.

The leader looks up in shock. Not giving them room to do anything else, Adora punches them. They won't be waking up any time soon.

"Nice one! Still saving my ass, huh?" Glimmer says. As Adora rises to her feet, she sees Glimmer has won their fight.

"Sure am! Think you can handle one more?" Adora smirks.

"Let's see who beats who first."

Adora sets her sights on the bandit with a large, serrated knife in their hands. *Looks easy enough* she thinks to herself. The two split up and get ready for their respective fights. The bandit before Adora ends up being quick on their feet, jumping out of the way from her attack. When their knife comes at Adora, she blocks it with her own weapon.

She moves away from her foe, giving herself some breathing room. As she thinks about her next move, the bandit lunges forward. Their weapon is poised to strike, to slice and dice her. There only is a moment to think. Just as they come close and Adora can see the bright shine of the metal glistening off their weapon, she does the only thing she can.

Adora jumps back, easily landing on her feet. As she comes back to earth, she feels the sole of a foot brushing against some rubble. In a swift and fluid motion, she kicks it towards her opponent. The chunk sails through the air before connecting with

the bandit's head. They groan before collapsing to the ground, their knife bouncing away from view.

"Ha! Eat shit jackass!" Adora shouts.

Fingers suddenly wrap around her wrist. She does not have to turn around to know it's Glimmer's hands that tug her away. The blonde spots another bandit coming up, eyes widen with horror and rage at their fallen brethren. Adora promptly flips them off as she is dragged away.

Adora does not resist Glimmer. She quickly begins to follow her friend through an alleyway. They climb over half broken, chain link fence and around some large, broken pieces of rubble. Adora can hear the bandits shouting in the distance and their guns and glass shattering . It's followed by the low groans of zombies. Not good. Not good at *all.* Thankfully, Glimmer spots something Adora doesn't.

They let go of Adora before slamming their shoulders against a door. It takes several blows before it flies open, slamming against the inner wall. The moment both are inside, Glimmer shuts the door. Adora spots a forgotten table and quickly forces it in front of the door. Not wasting a moment more, the two sprint up the stairs. As she jumps over holes and searches for any sort of refugee, Adora feels her head spin. She gasps for the air her lungs desperately need and wonders how she is so winded already.

No matter, she shakes her head, clearing it. The world becomes steady once more. Just in time for her to spot an open door. "There!" she shouts, spinning on her heels. Glimmer trails right behind her. The moment they are in the abandoned apartment, they slam the door shut. Adora quickly finds a large dresser.

However, this time, she finds her strength almost non-existence. It's as if someone has *sapped* it all when she wasn't looking. Adora gasps and groans as she pushes what feels like a ton of hot lead. She gasps and groans, feeling her legs becoming like jell-o.

Adora nearly slips before Glimmer comes. With their strength, the dresser is pushed in front of the door.

“Man that was a pain in the ass,” Adora grumbles.

“That’s not like you. You normally could do that yourself,” Glimmer states.

“Probably all the running and fighting. Haven’t done that in a hot while.” Adora brushes them off. She walks over to the window, peering through the glass. She sees a small fire burning at one corner of the streets. A horde of zombies ignore it, seeking their next meal. The rest of the bandits struggle to fend them off.

“Looks like we missed a hell of a bullet,” Glimmer says, looking at the mess outside. “Is it wrong that I don’t feel bad for them?”

Adora shrugs. “Who knows. No one should be eaten alive but seeing the shit they tried to pull, it’s karma.”

She then moves away from the window, smiling from ear to ear. “But did you see us kicking ass out there?!? I don’t think those bandits knew what they were up against!”

Glimmer pulls their sights away from the window and onto Adora. They have their own smile on their face. “I loved their faces as we started to get an upper hand.” Suddenly, their eyes grow.

“You know, that actually was alotta fun!” Adora chirps. She pumps her fist in the air. “Fighting zombies has become such a bore I didn’t know how much I needed a good fistfight.”

“Adora.”

“If any of those bastards survive, I hope they tell their buddies not to mess with us. You think we can make a name for ourselves?”

“Adora!”

“Yeah, maybe that is not the best idea. Sorry, I’m just so pumped! I didn’t think we would win yet we did! Well sort of! Though at least we made away pretty much unscathed”

“ *Adora!”*

Adora freezes in place. She never heard them raise their voice like this, not since they first met each other. When sky blue eyes land on Glimmer, she sees how pale their face has become. A hand covers their mouth. Tears threaten to spill down their cheeks. With their throat most likely tight as a knot, Glimmer points. Adora follows.

She looks down at her side. Her shirt has been torn open. Red already stains the fabric and blood flows freely downward. Adora can see how deep the injury goes. Glimmer’s wound from before looks like a papercut compared to this. The last of her strength disappears. Adora can only chuckle slightly, sights returning to Glimmer, before saying, “Guess I spoke too soon!”

The last thing she sees before darkness takes over is Glimmer’s horrified face.

Adora feels like she has been thrown into tar. Black and sticky. She cannot move. Any attempts she makes are met with resistance. Every part of her body feels like weights are tied around them. When Adora tries to look around, she finds no sources of lights. She begins to wonder if her eyes are even open.

Though, there is one thing that breaks through this all. The muffled sound of Glimmer.

“Adora! Fuck! Adora, stay with me!”

Adora cannot pinpoint where they are. The tar refuses to budge. It has actually begun to sap what little energy she has left, threatening to destroy what little consciousness she has left.

“Okay, okay, Adora! This is gonna hurt like a bitch. But I have to do it. Please stay with me.”

She feels Glimmer’s soft hands brush against her cheeks. Adora sighs, wishing to bury herself in the sensation. Glimmer mumbles something before placing an unknown object in Adora’s mouth. By the taste, its cloth. Adora begins to question this. What are they planning?

The moment pain erupts from her side, all thoughts and questions leave her mind. If it wasn’t for the cloth in her mouth, Adora damn near could shatter her teeth from how hard she bites down. It is as if she has been thrown into an active, bubbling volcano but also as if all her nerves are being pulled out of her. Adora feels hot tears begin following down her cheeks.

“I’m sorry, Adora! I’m sorry!” Glimmer says, their voice clear yet worried. The blackness begins to fade, revealing muddled colors. Adora can make out Glimmer’s raven hair and their amethyst eyes. “I *have* to do this. It will be over soon, I promise.”

Adora wants to reach out and ask them what they are doing. Ask them what is wrong. Had they not just won a fight and gotten away? Why on this hell on earth would that make them sad? If only she could escape this tar infested world.

More pain. More tears. Adora feels her whole body tense up. Glimmer continues to apologize and begs Adora to stay with them. That is another question that pops into her mind. Adora is right *here.* Where do they think she is going? If there is one thing she wishes to say, it's that ‘ *I am right here, Glimmer!’*

Finally, the pain begins to subside. It fails to fully go away, every breath she takes causes tiny needles to prick at her body. But no more lava. No more feeling like she is being literally torn up. Glimmer’s soft hands return to her face.

“Please don’t die on me!” they beg, choking on their words. Adora feels their tears dripping onto her face. “I don’t want to lose you.

I *can't* lose you! Please, Adora, please…Stay with me…"

Adora's heart twists in their chest. The colors have begun to fadem leaving only the blackness. She struggles against it, wanting nothing more than to comfort Glimmer in their time of need. However, she loses.

Adora is only somewhat conscious at random times. Sometimes, she feels, sees, and hears nothing. Other times, Adora can feel herself lying on something as well as Glimmer's hand stroking her cheeks. Occasionally, she hears them whispering words of comfort.

On and off it goes until Adora begins to hear new voices. The first time she does, Glimmer's is far from welcoming. They threaten whoever has appeared and nearly causes a fight to break out by the sounds of it. However, things begin to calm. Whatever Glimmer says to these unknown people, Adora cannot make out.

The next thing she knows is being jerked around. The pain from before returns and Adora wishes to feel nothing again. It has become almost unbearable. Yet, Glimmer remains at her side through it all, doing whatever they can to comfort her until she slips into nothingness.

……

Adora has no idea how long she has been unconscious for. When she opens her eyes, she is met with the starry night sky. Crickets chirp away and the sounds of wood cracking under the heat of fire fills her ears. Slowly, the blonde turns her head, spotting the nearby campfire. However, that is not the only thing. All around her is a chain link fence, barred wired resting on top. There are small structures all around her that people stream in and out of. The moment she sees all the strange faces, panic sets in. She attempts to sit up but is stopped by a sharp pain at her side.

“Woah! Calm down!” a familiar voice says. Hands press down on her chest and she is brought down to what she realizes is a cot. Glimmer appears in her vision. “It’s okay!”

“Where are we?” Adora asks, her throat dry. “And what happened?”

Glimmer’s fingers brush back some dark locks that rests on Adora’s face. “Well, for starters, you nearly died on me. Guess that is what I get when I nearly did that to you.”

“What?”

“A bandit got you really good. You were bleeding a lot and I had to do a crude surgery on you.”

They gesture their head. Adora looks down, realizing she is only in her bra and boxers. Her whole lower half is wrapped in a white bandage. She reaches down and brushes her fingers against her side. The moment the *tips* of her fingers touch it, the pain from before returns.

“Shit, you weren’t kidding,” she hisses through her teeth.

“Probably gonna scar but you’ll live. Thankfully. Which brings us to the next thing. You’re never gonna believe it.”

Adora raises an eyebrow. “Which is?”

“A safety zone.”

“ *What?!?”*

Glimmer gives a nod. “Yeah. A couple days after you passed out some people came. Was ready to fight to the death in order to protect you but they said they wanted to help. And well, they brought us here. There is food, water, clothing, and so much more. People are here are really nice. Which is gonna take some getting used to.”

“I can’t believe this is real. Have you been at my side the whole time? I kept hearing your voice. Sorry if I scared you.”

“I’m just happy you are okay. I was scared I was going to lose you. I can’t imagine my life without you.”

Adora chuckles a little. She feels her body wishing for more sleep. “I can say the same. But I am here now. And I won’t be leaving anytime soon.”

She reaches a hand out, wrapping her fingers around Glimmer’s palm. They do not protest and even wrap their own fingers around Adora’s hand.

“We can stay here now and not have to worry about anything. I kind of like that. What about you?”

“I like it also. Though, I like any place with you in it.”

Glimmer rolls their eyes. “I know you are gonna hate me saying this but go back to bed. You need it.”

Adora smiles softly. She can’t protest that, especially when she knows when she wakes up, Glimmer will be right there with her.

End Notes

comments/kudos appreciated

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